POLYTECHNIC UNIVERSITY OF THE PHILIPPINES
STA. MESA MANILA
COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING

Self-Study Report (SSR)

Bachelor of Science in Civil Engineering

Criterion 3
Students

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A LEADING COMPREHENSIVE POLYTECHNIC UNIVERSITY IN ASIA

CRITERION 3. STUDENTS

3.1 Student Admissions

Pursuant to Presidential Decree No. 1341, the Polytechnic University of the Philippines (PUP) is mandated to expand academic offerings in polytechnic and technological fields and to establish branches, consortia, and linkages to enhance access to quality higher education. This legal framework supports the University's structured, system-wide admission process, which is designed to maintain a balance between accessibility and academic rigor (Attachment C3-01 – Presidential Decree No. 1341).

Institutional governance of admission policies is vested in the Board of Regents (BOR), which exercises corporate powers and approves policies governing student admissions, retention, and graduation. The Office of the University Registrar, operating under the Office of the Vice President for Student Affairs and Services, implements these policies and ensures compliance with both institutional guidelines and national regulations.

The University Registrar, appointed by the University President and confirmed by the BOR, supervises the Assistant University Registrar and the Chief of the Admission and Registration Services Section (ARSS). These offices collectively manage the student lifecycle, encompassing admission processing, enrollment monitoring, and graduation verification, thereby ensuring policy consistency, data integrity, and procedural transparency.

3.1.1 Admission

The Admission and Registration Services Section (ARSS), in coordination with the Information and Communications Technology Office (ICTO), administers the PUP College Entrance Test (PUPCET) through the PUP iApply system. This web-based platform enables:

- Online application and data capture
- Automated scheduling of examination shifts
- Generation of applicant e-Permits
- Centralized database reporting

Since School Year 2017–2018, the implementation of the e-Permit system has enhanced operational efficiency, reduced manual processing errors, and improved applicant accessibility across the Main Campus and branch campuses.

Due to pandemic-related restrictions on physical gatherings, the University conducted admissions for Academic Years 2021–2022 and 2022–2023 through the College Admission

Evaluation of PUP (CAEPUP). CAEPUP is a systematic, points-based evaluation process that assesses applicants based on academic credentials, such as senior high school grades, and other admission requirements, serving as an alternative to the traditional centralized entrance examination (PUPCET) during the pandemic. This approach ensured continuity in student recruitment while adhering to public health protocols.

After three years of postponement due to pandemic restrictions, the PUP College Entrance Test (PUPCET) resumed on January 28, 2023 for the Academic Year 2023–2024, marking the return of in-person examinations. The decision to return to the traditional, in-person PUPCET was guided by several considerations, including the alignment of examination questions with the K–12 program curriculum. This adjustment ensured that the entrance assessment remained relevant to current secondary education outcomes and allowed PUP to maintain academic standards and fairness in the selection of incoming students.

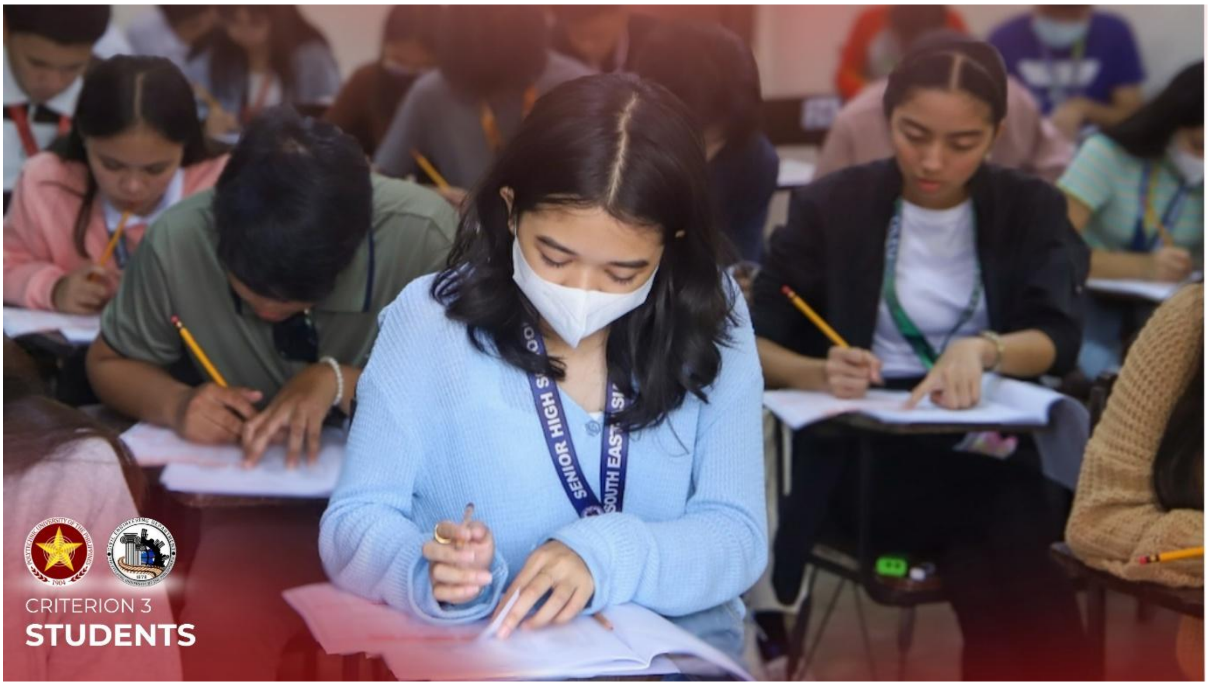

Figure 3.1. *The PUP College Entrance Test (PUPCET) 2023 marked the resumption of face-to-face admission examinations following two academic years of implementing the College Admission Evaluation of PUP (CAEPUP) during the COVID-19 pandemic. The activity reflected the University's transition back to standardized in-person assessment while maintaining equitable and merit-based admission procedures.*

The operationalization of PUPCET requires coordinated efforts among University offices, ensuring standardized procedures and compliance with established admission policies, which facilitates effective administration and sets the stage for the active involvement of the Admission and Registration Services Section (ARSS). ARSS works closely with the

Guidance and Counseling Office in the conduct of PUPCET. Faculty and personnel serve as trained examiners and proctors to ensure standardized administration procedures, thereby safeguarding test validity and reliability.

3.1.2 Admission Processing

Applicants who successfully pass the PUP College Entrance Test (PUPCET) undergo document authentication and eligibility verification. The Admission and Registration Services Section (ARSS) evaluates the completeness and authenticity of submitted credentials to ensure compliance with the University's admission criteria and policies.

As part of the admission processing stage, qualified applicants are required to present the Student Admission Record (SAR) Form or Confirmation Slip, which serves as an official document confirming their eligibility to proceed with interview, document verification, and enrollment procedures. The SAR Form or Confirmation Slip contains essential applicant information and is used by the Department and the Admission and Registration Services Section (ARSS) to validate the applicant's examination result, program assignment, admission status, and compliance with documentary requirements (Attachment C3-02 – Student Admission Record Form or Confirmation Slip).

Figure 3.2 *The PUPCET 2023 admission processing included a rigorous interview and evaluation of qualified applicants who successfully passed the entrance examination. Department chairpersons administered the screening and enrollment procedures to verify program suitability, compliance with admission requirements, and readiness for formal enrollment.*

The University enforces a Selective Admission and Retention Policy, which requires that students admitted through PUPCET must:

- Be Senior High School graduates who have not previously enrolled in any higher education or technical/vocational institution prior to enrollment in PUP;
- Submit all required documentary requirements for formal admission; and
- Comply with University rules and regulations.

This policy ensures that incoming students possess the foundational competencies necessary to succeed in their chosen programs, while maintaining equitable access to higher education. The verification process and adherence to admission criteria support consistent alignment with program learning outcomes and institutional quality standards.

3.1.3 General Guidelines for Undergraduate Applicants

Admission policies adhere to principles of fairness, equity, and merit-based selection:

- No applicant is denied admission on the basis of age, gender, nationality, race, religious belief, or political affiliation.
- All applicants must comply with University, College, and Campus-specific admission requirements.
- Eligibility for freshman application requires graduation from Senior High School without prior enrollment in a post-secondary technical, diploma, or degree program.
- Applicants must have at least 82% Grade 12 average in Mathematics, English, and Science, with a minimum General Weighted Average (GWA) of 82%.
- Applicants must undergo required physical and medical examinations.
- Students must abide by all University rules and regulations upon admission.

3.1.4 Admission of Returnees, Shiftees, and Transferees

The ARSS also processes applications of returning students, shiftees, and transferees under structured and capacity-based policies.

- **Returnees** are evaluated based on prior academic performance, compliance with readmission requirements, and availability of program slots.
- **Transferees from PUP Branches/Campuses** require endorsement from the Branch Director and must satisfy program-specific academic standards.
- **External transferees** are admitted subject to slot availability and verification that they meet academic and institutional admission requirements.

These mechanisms ensure that admissions across all entry pathways maintain academic integrity and preserve program quality standards consistent with PTC–ACBET expectations.

As stated in the PUP Student Handbook, admission to the Polytechnic University of the Philippines is open to all qualified applicants, as determined by the applicant's readiness, preparedness, and capacity to contribute to the enrichment of the academic community (Attachment C3-03 – PUP Student Handbook). The Student Handbook serves as an official institutional reference for student-related policies, including admission, enrollment, retention, student conduct, and graduation requirements. Its implementation is supported by the approval and policy authority of the Board of Regents (BOR), which exercises institutional governance over major academic and administrative policies of the University.

The BOR approval of the Student Handbook ensures that admission policies and related student regulations are formally reviewed, institutionally adopted, and consistently implemented across colleges, campuses, and academic units. This provides a policy-based foundation for ensuring fairness, transparency, and academic integrity in the admission and retention of students (Attachment C3-04 – BOR Approval of the PUP Student Handbook).

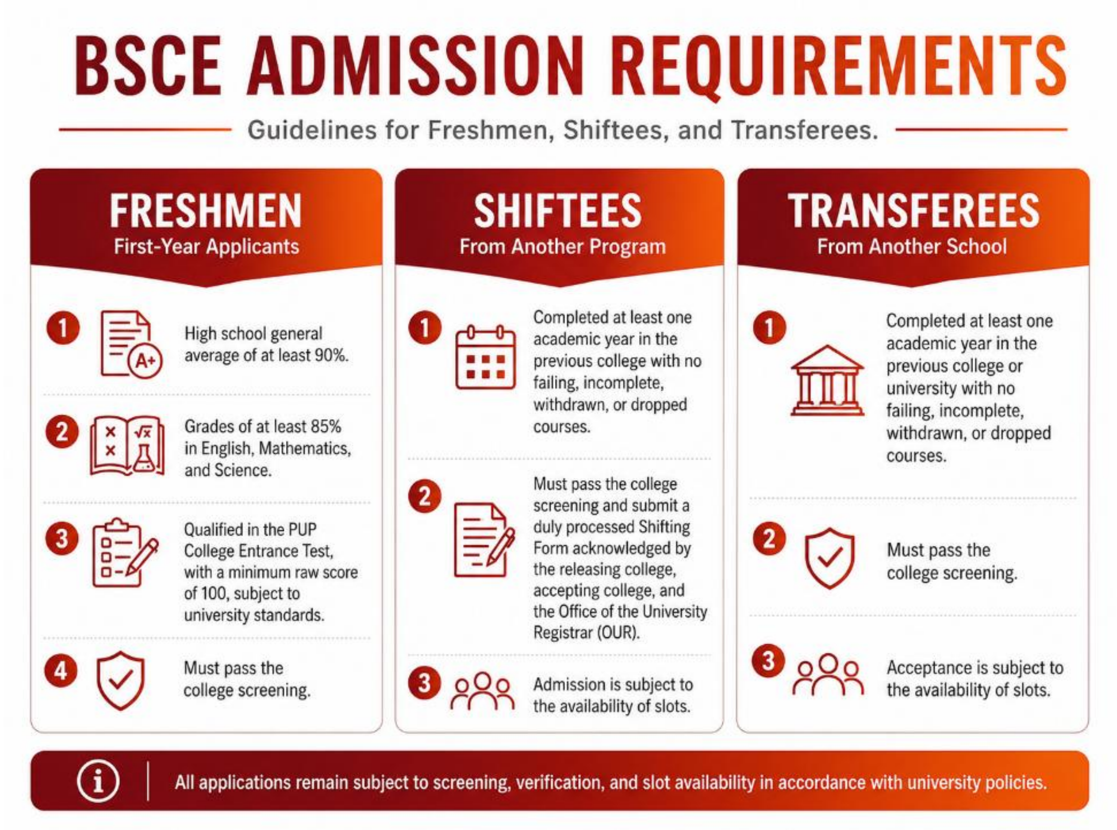

Figure 3.3 The BSCE Program Admission Requirements

Table 3.1 Admission Criteria of the BSCE Program

Program	Minimum Grade 12 GWA	Minimum SHS Average in Math	Minimum SHS Average in Science	Minimum SHS Average in English	Aligned SHS Track	Other SHS Tracks/Graduate Type Allowed but With Additional Bridging Subjects
Bachelor of Science in Civil Engineering (BSCE)	88	86	86	86	Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics (STEM)	Other SHS Tracks/Graduate Type Allowed But With Additional Bridging Subjects [to take Basic Calculus (3 units) and General Physics (3units)]

Table 3.1 presents the admission criteria for the BS Civil Engineering program, which serve as the basis for determining the academic eligibility and readiness of applicants. The program requires a minimum Grade 12 General Weighted Average (GWA) of 88, with minimum Senior High School averages of 86 in Mathematics, Science, and English. The aligned Senior High School track for the program is Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics (STEM), as this track provides the foundational preparation in mathematics and sciences needed for engineering education. However, graduates from other Senior High School tracks or graduate types may also be admitted, provided that they take the prescribed additional bridging subjects, including Basic Calculus and General Physics. These admission criteria ensure that incoming students possess the necessary academic foundation for the analytical, scientific, and technical requirements of the BS Civil Engineering curriculum, while also providing an academic support mechanism for non-STEM graduates through the bridging program (Attachment C3-05 – PUP Admission Criteria).

Freshmen

1. Must have attained a high school general average not lower than 88%.
2. Must have a grade not lower than 86% for English, Math, and Science subjects taken in high school.
3. Passed the PUP College Entrance Test with a raw score not lower than 100 points (subject to changes depending on university set qualification mark for PUPCET – either by percentile or raw score).

4. Passed the college screening.
5. Senior High School graduates from non-STEM tracks shall be required to take the BS Civil Engineering Bridging Program.
6. The bridging program shall consist of eight (8) additional course credit units, specifically Basic Calculus and General Physics, to ensure sufficient foundational preparation before taking the prescribed mathematics and physical science courses of the program.
7. To accommodate the additional bridging units without exceeding the prescribed maximum academic load, some first-year course subjects may be displaced and taken during the summer semester of the first-year level.

Shiftees

1. Must have completed at least one (1) year residence in previous college with no failing grade, incomplete, and/or withdrawn/dropped course.
2. Passed the college screening and filed a Shifting Form duly released, accepted and acknowledged by the releasing college, accepting college, and OUR respectively.
3. Passed the college qualifying examination.
4. Acceptance of the application for shifting to the program is subject to the availability of slots.

Transferees

1. Must have completed at least one (1) year residence in previous college/university with no failing grade, incomplete, and/or withdrawn/dropped course.
2. Passed the college screening.
3. Passed the college qualifying examination.
4. Acceptance of application for transferees to the program is subject to the availability of slots.

3.1.5 Ladderized Program

The Polytechnic University of the Philippines (PUP) implements a structured ladderized education framework to promote academic mobility, lifelong learning, and inclusive access to engineering education. Ladderized education harmonizes technical-vocational and higher education pathways, enabling students to transition vertically between diploma and baccalaureate programs without compromising academic standards or program learning outcomes.

Within this framework, the Diploma in Civil Engineering Technology (DCET) serves as a foundation for progression into the Bachelor of Science in Civil Engineering (BSCE) program. The DCET is a three-year program designed to develop competencies in construction engineering, quantity surveying, building systems, materials testing, construction safety, surveying, and related civil engineering technology fields through traditional, experiential, and digital learning modalities. Graduates who meet admission and performance requirements are eligible to matriculate into the BSCE program, in accordance with the Philippine Qualifications Framework (Level 5), TESDA competency standards, and CHED Memorandum Order No. 92, Series of 2017.

Figure 3.4 *The TESDA training provided Diploma in Civil Engineering Technology students with competency-based instruction in areas such as carpentry, construction painting, scaffolding, technical drafting, and tile setting. Through TESDA's construction-related qualifications and National Certificate programs, students developed industry-recognized technical competencies applicable to entry-level and supervisory roles in the construction sector.*

The ladderized mechanism provides flexible entry and exit points, allowing students to earn Certificate and Associate degrees at the first and second years, respectively. First-year graduates may obtain a Certificate in Civil Engineering Technology, qualifying them for roles such as CAD operators, carpenters, and rebar installers. Completion of the second year leads to an Associate in Civil Engineering Technology, enabling employment as land surveyors, safety engineers, or surveying assistants. The three-year diploma prepares students for professional positions, including civil engineering technologist/technician, structural detailer, BIM modeler, construction site engineer, and project-in-charge. Each level is reinforced with

TESDA National Certificates, validating technical competencies and enhancing employability in both local and global industries.

The ladderized pathway is governed by Executive Order No. 42, Series of 2021, which provides revised guidelines on enrollment to vertically aligned baccalaureate degree programs (Attachment C3-06 – Executive Order No. 42, Series of 2021).

The policy establishes:

- Admission qualifications and academic performance thresholds;
- Qualifying examination requirements, where applicable;
- Evaluation and crediting of previously completed courses; and
- Institutional controls to ensure academic equivalency.

These guidelines, together with the DCET–BSCE articulation, ensure that transitions from diploma to degree programs are merit-based, quality-assured, and aligned with outcomes-based education principles. They promote curriculum integrity, competency development, and alignment with institutional Student Outcomes (SOs), thereby facilitating both academic mobility and lifelong learning opportunities for students.

The following are the requirements to be qualified to enroll to the vertically articulated baccalaureate degree programs.

1. The student applicant must have obtained a General Weighted Average (GWA) of at least 2.0;
2. The student applicant must not have either Dropped, Withdrawn or failing grade/s in academic courses;
3. The student applicant must pass the qualifying examination to be developed and administered by the host College;
4. Qualified student applicant shall enroll in the same Branch/Campus where he/she took the diploma program. However, if the Branch/Campus does not offer the appropriate baccalaureate degree program, the applicant may enroll in the Main Campus or to any Branch/Campus where it is offered.
5. Student applicants with at least GWA of 2.0 and have appropriate TESDA skills certification (NC) and other skills certifications to be evaluated by the accepting department shall be exempted from taking the qualifying examination or be given certain percentage in the qualifying exam.

6. The over-all passing percentage for the qualifying examination is 75 for Information Technology, 70 for Engineering programs and Office Administration.
7. All courses taken from the ladderized program may be credited by the accepting department, subject to the evaluation of the courses.

3.1.6 Foreign Students

The Polytechnic University of the Philippines maintains a structured and policy-driven admission system for international students to ensure compliance with national regulations, institutional standards, and outcomes-based education (OBE) principles. The admission of foreign students is administered in coordination with the Office of International Affairs, the Office of the University Registrar, and relevant government agencies.

International student admission follows a defined academic calendar to ensure timely processing of academic requirements and immigration documentation. Early application is strongly encouraged to allow sufficient time for the conversion of a temporary visa to a Student Visa or Special Study Permit through the Bureau of Immigration.

Applications are processed in accordance with the University's admission policies and are subject to:

- Academic qualification and readiness assessment
- Verification and authentication of credentials
- Compliance with immigration and health regulations

International students may apply as:

- Incoming Freshmen – graduating or graduate high school students with above-average academic performance and good moral character
- Transferees – students currently enrolled in other higher education institutions seeking admission to PUP

Qualifications and Requirements for International Students:

International applicants must demonstrate academic preparedness, financial capability, and legal eligibility through submission of the following requirements:

- Accomplished Application Form for International Students
- Two (2) recommendation letters attesting to academic potential, English proficiency, character, and readiness for overseas study
- Authenticated Transcript of Records and one certified true copy
- Authenticated passport data page and birth certificate (or equivalent)

- Notarized Affidavit of Support with supporting financial documents
- Authenticated police clearance or certificate of non-criminality
- Medical Health Certificate from the Bureau of Quarantine
- Medical clearance issued by the PUP Medical Clinic
- Personal History Statement with photograph and thumbprints
- Recent passport-size photographs
- Additional civil documents, when applicable (e.g., marriage certificate)

PUP ensures equitable access and support for international students throughout their academic journey. This includes guidance on curriculum requirements, course registration, academic advising, and compliance with program and graduation standards. International students also benefit from orientation programs, career counseling, and enrichment activities that facilitate integration into campus life and professional preparation in civil engineering and allied fields.

Admission and support of international students are further guided by the **PUP Diversity and Inclusion Policy** (Attachment C3-07 – Executive Order No. 20, Series of 2023), which reflects the University's commitment to fostering an inclusive and respectful environment for all students, regardless of nationality, cultural background, or other personal characteristics. This policy ensures that foreign students are recognized, valued, and provided equitable opportunities to succeed academically and professionally within the PUP community.

Through these structured processes and policy frameworks, PUP guarantees that international students are well-prepared to achieve academic success, meet program Student Outcomes (SOs), and transition effectively into professional practice.

3.1.7 English Proficiency and Bridging Mechanism

To ensure readiness for academic instruction delivered in English, applicants may be required to submit proof of English proficiency:

- IELTS (minimum 4.5–5.0) or
- TOEFL (minimum 480–500)

Applicants who do not fully meet the required proficiency level are required to undergo:

- English Placement Testing, and
- Intensive English Bridging Program prior to formal enrollment

This bridging mechanism ensures that international students can effectively engage in outcomes-based instruction and meet course-level learning requirements.

3.1.8 Psychological Assessment of Transfer Students

As part of the admission process for transferees, the Polytechnic University of the Philippines (PUP) requires the administration of a **psychological assessment** to qualified applicants. This process is jointly implemented by the Admission and Registration Services Section (ARSS) in coordination with the Office of Guidance and Psychological Services (OGPS).

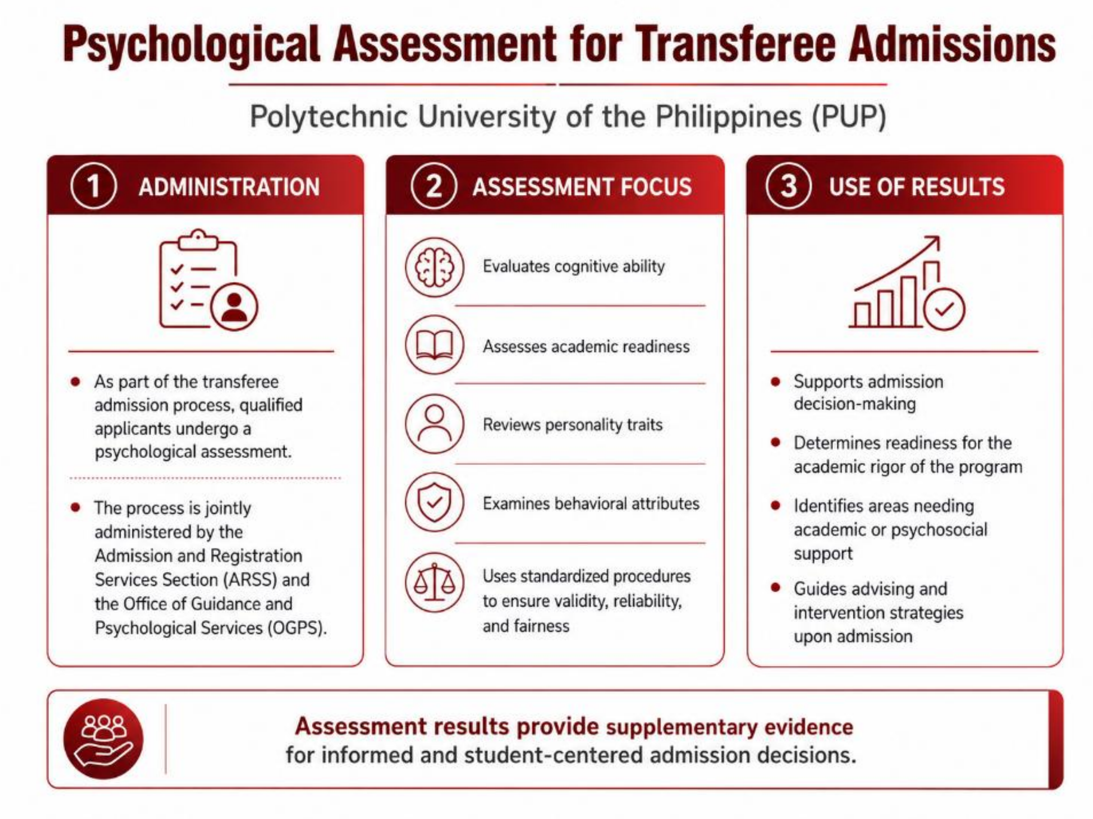

Figure 3.5 Psychological Assessment Process for Transferee Admissions

The psychological assessment is designed to evaluate the applicant's **cognitive abilities, academic readiness, personality traits, and behavioral attributes**, which are essential for successful adaptation to the academic and social environment of the University. Standardized testing procedures are employed to ensure validity, reliability, and fairness in the evaluation process.

Results of the psychological assessment serve as **supplementary evidence** in admission decision-making and are used to:

- Determine the applicant's readiness for the academic rigor of the program

- Identify potential areas requiring academic or psychosocial support
- Inform advising and intervention strategies upon admission

3.1.9 Best Strategies in Admission and Retention of Students

The Polytechnic University of the Philippines implements a selective admission and structured retention system designed to ensure that students admitted into the program possess the academic preparedness and personal competencies necessary to successfully attain the defined Student Outcomes (SOs). Given the high volume of applicants annually, the University is able to apply rigorous screening mechanisms, thereby maintaining quality standards while promoting equitable access.

1. Standardized Entrance Examination (PUPCET)

The **PUP College Entrance Test (PUPCET)** serves as the primary screening mechanism for incoming freshmen. It is developed and periodically reviewed by a panel of academic experts composed of faculty members and university officials across disciplines.

2. Adaptive Admission Policy (CAEPUP)

In response to extraordinary circumstances such as the COVID-19 pandemic, the University implemented the **CAEPUP (Criteria for Admission to PUP)** as an alternative admission mechanism. This policy ensured continuity of access while maintaining academic standards through:

- Evaluation of academic records and scholastic performance
- Use of predefined selection criteria in lieu of in-person examinations
- Compliance with national health and safety protocols

3. Compliance with Republic Act No. 10931 (Free Higher Education)

PUP adheres to **Republic Act No. 10931**, also known as the *Universal Access to Quality Tertiary Education Act*, which enables qualified students to avail of free tuition and other school fees (Attachment C3-08 – Republic Act No. 10931).

Eligibility is contingent upon:

- Meeting all admission and retention requirements
- Compliance with prescribed program duration limits
- Absence of prior completion of a bachelor’s degree or equivalent

Section 6. Exceptions to Free Tertiary Education – the following students are ineligible to avail of free tertiary education:

(a) In SUCs and LUCs

(1) Students who have already attained a bachelor's degree or comparable undergraduate degree from any HEI, whether public or private;

(2) Students who fail to comply with the admission and retention policies of the SUC or LUC;

(3) Students who fail to complete their bachelor's degree or comparable undergraduate degree within a year after the period prescribed in their program; and

(b) In State-Run TVIs

(1) Students who have obtained a bachelor's degree, as well as those who have received a certificate or diploma for a technical-vocational course equivalent to at least National Certificate III and above;

(2) Students who fail in any course are enrolled during the course of the program.

Students who are ineligible to avail of the free tertiary education shall be charged the tuition and other school fees, as determined by the respective boards of the SUCs and LUCs, and in the case of the state-run TVIs, to be determined by the TESDA.

This provision supports equitable access to higher education while reinforcing the importance of academic responsibility, compliance with institutional policies, and timely program completion. For the BS Civil Engineering program, compliance with Republic Act No. 10931 ensures that qualified students are able to pursue engineering education with reduced financial burden, provided that they continue to satisfy the University's admission, retention, and residency requirements.

The policy therefore contributes to student access and retention by helping remove financial barriers that may affect students' ability to continue and complete the program. At the same time, the conditions and exceptions stated in the law emphasize that free higher education is linked to satisfactory academic standing and responsible progression within the prescribed program duration. This supports the Department's implementation of retention and monitoring mechanisms, as students are expected to maintain compliance with academic requirements to remain eligible for the benefits provided under the law.

3.2 Evaluating Student Performance

Effective academic advising and career guidance constitute integral components of the Polytechnic University of the Philippines student support system, ensuring that students are systematically guided toward the successful completion of their academic program and the attainment of Student Outcomes (SOs). The University implements a structured advising mechanism to provide students with comprehensive knowledge of academic policies, curriculum requirements, career pathways, employment opportunities, and available instructional support services.

Upon entry, incoming freshmen and transfer students receive individualized academic counseling from a faculty adviser, who assists in the development of a personalized plan of study (Attachment C3-09 – Students' Plan of Study). This plan is reviewed periodically in collaboration with the adviser and updated as necessary to ensure academic progress, compliance with program requirements, and alignment with graduation standards. While the University provides structured guidance, the ultimate responsibility for fulfilling all degree requirements resides with the student.

Faculty advisers play a critical role in supporting curriculum planning, career development, and preparation for graduate or professional studies. They facilitate access to supplementary advising resources, including internships, independent research, guided independent studies, and professional development opportunities. Faculty members are expected to maintain accessibility to their advisees, and students are strongly encouraged to maintain regular communication, particularly before making modifications to their academic plan. Additionally, consultation with the Program Chair is required prior to each semester's enrollment to ensure coherence with program progression and SO attainment.

A dedicated guidance counselor is assigned to the College to provide specialized support services addressing academic, career, and personal development concerns. The Guidance and Counseling Office conducts enrichment seminars designed to enhance self-awareness, values formation, goal setting, and skill development, thereby supporting students' holistic growth and their preparedness for professional practice in civil engineering and allied fields.

To ensure systematic and evidence-based evaluation of student performance, the Department employs multiple assessment rubrics aligned with **Course Intended Learning Outcomes (CILOs)** and **Student Outcomes (SOs)**, incorporating associated performance indicators. These rubrics provide consistent and objective measures across different domains of student learning, supporting formative and summative assessment, as well as continuous quality improvement (Attachment C3-10 – Assessment Rubrics).

The assessment of CILOs and SOs is conducted through both **direct and indirect assessment methods**. Direct assessment refers to the evaluation of actual student work and performance, including examinations, laboratory reports, design projects, case studies, research outputs, oral presentations, internship reports, and capstone or major design activities. These outputs are assessed using rubrics that contain clearly defined criteria, performance levels, and indicators aligned with the intended outcomes of the course and the corresponding SOs.

Indirect assessment, on the other hand, gathers evidence from stakeholder perceptions, reflections, and feedback mechanisms that provide supporting information on the extent of student learning and preparedness. These may include student course evaluations, exit surveys, internship supervisor feedback, alumni feedback, employer feedback, advising records, and graduate tracer data. While indirect assessment does not measure student performance through actual outputs, it provides valuable evidence on the effectiveness of instruction, student support services, curriculum relevance, and graduates' readiness for professional practice.

The combined use of direct and indirect assessment provides a more comprehensive basis for evaluating student learning and program effectiveness. Direct evidence demonstrates whether students have attained the required CILOs, SOs, and performance indicators, while indirect evidence supports the interpretation of results by capturing stakeholder perspectives on student development, professional readiness, and curriculum relevance. The results of these assessments are reviewed and used to identify performance gaps, strengthen Teaching-Learning Activities (TLAs), improve Assessment Tasks (ATs), refine advising and support mechanisms, and inform Continuous Quality Improvement (CQI) actions.

These assessment mechanisms collectively ensure that student learning in the BS Civil Engineering program is rigorously evaluated, aligned with program outcomes, and reflective of both technical competencies and professional skills (Attachment C3-11 – Direct and Indirect Assessment of CILOs and SOs).

3.3 Monitoring Student Progress

The Polytechnic University of the Philippines implements a structured and systematic process for monitoring student progress, commencing upon admission and continuing throughout the student's academic lifecycle. This process ensures alignment with curriculum requirements, timely progression, and attainment of **Student Outcomes (SOs)**. Monitoring is implemented through academic advising, curriculum tracking, student portfolio documentation, Student Information System (SIS) records, student consultations, guidance services, and coordinated interventions involving faculty advisers, the Program Chair, student representatives, alumni, and student organizations.

Upon admission, each student is provided with a **Curriculum Sheet**, which details the prescribed sequence of courses required for program completion. This document serves as the primary reference for academic planning, ensuring that course enrollment follows a logical and outcomes-aligned progression consistent with program design. The Curriculum Sheet is used by students, faculty advisers, and the Program Chair to verify course completion, prerequisite compliance, remaining academic requirements, and readiness for higher-level professional and integrative courses.

Each student in the **Bachelor of Science in Civil Engineering (BSCE)** program is assigned a faculty academic adviser responsible for monitoring academic performance, guiding course selection and load planning, and ensuring compliance with program requirements. The designation of faculty advisers is supported by an official **Special Order**, which formalizes the advising assignments and clarifies the responsibility of faculty members in assisting students throughout their academic progression (Attachment C3-12 – Special Order on Faculty Academic Advisers). This mechanism ensures accountability, consistency, and traceability in the implementation of academic advising.

The advising process is documented through the **Academic and Career Advising Form**, which records the student's academic standing, course performance, planned academic load, specialization or track concerns, board examination preparation, and career goals (Attachment C3-13 – Academic and Career Advising Form). Advising integrates both academic planning and career guidance, thereby supporting students in achieving SOs, preparing for professional practice, and identifying appropriate pathways for specialization, internship, graduate studies, licensure preparation, and career development.

The advising process is further supported by a **student portfolio**, which serves as a centralized repository of evidence documenting academic and professional progression. The portfolio is regularly updated and includes records such as completed courses, grades, laboratory reports, research outputs, case studies, design projects, internship submissions, and other learning outputs. The portfolio provides a traceable record of student development, linking student performance to **Course Intended Learning Outcomes (CILOs), Student Outcomes (SOs), and associated performance indicators**, and is utilized in advising, evaluation, and accreditation processes (Attachment C3-14 – Student Portfolio).

During advising sessions, students discuss academic standing, progression, specialization or track selection, and career goals. The process also includes:

- Reviewing course completion and compliance with graduation requirements;
- Assessing readiness for board examinations, certifications, and professional practice;
- Identifying short-term and long-term career objectives; and
- Aligning experiential learning opportunities, such as laboratory work, design projects, case studies, and internships, with career pathways and industry expectations.

In addition to the portfolio, students maintain a checklist of key documentation, including records of grades, completed major examinations, design outputs, research reports, internship submissions, and other academic milestones. This mechanism provides traceable evidence for advising, evaluation, and accreditation purposes while supporting both formative and summative assessment. The checklist also allows faculty advisers and the Program Chair to identify students who may require academic intervention, course load adjustment, guidance referral, or additional support services.

The Department also conducts freshmen orientation during the first semester to assist first-year students in their transition to university life and engineering education. The orientation introduces students to the PUP Student Handbook, University policies, academic regulations, student conduct expectations, curriculum requirements, retention policies, student services, and available support mechanisms. Through this activity, incoming BS Civil Engineering students are guided on the academic standards, responsibilities, and procedures that they are expected to observe throughout their stay in the University. The orientation also provides students with information on course sequencing, enrollment procedures, advising mechanisms, grading policies, and other academic requirements necessary for their progression in the program.

In addition, the freshmen orientation serves as an early intervention and communication mechanism that helps students become familiar with the Department, faculty members, student support offices, and institutional resources available to them. It provides an opportunity to clarify student concerns, explain expectations in engineering education, and emphasize the importance of discipline, academic integrity, attendance, participation, and compliance with program requirements. By ensuring that first-year students are properly informed at the beginning of their academic journey, the Department promotes student adjustment, policy awareness, responsible academic planning, and timely progression toward the attainment of the program's Student Outcomes.

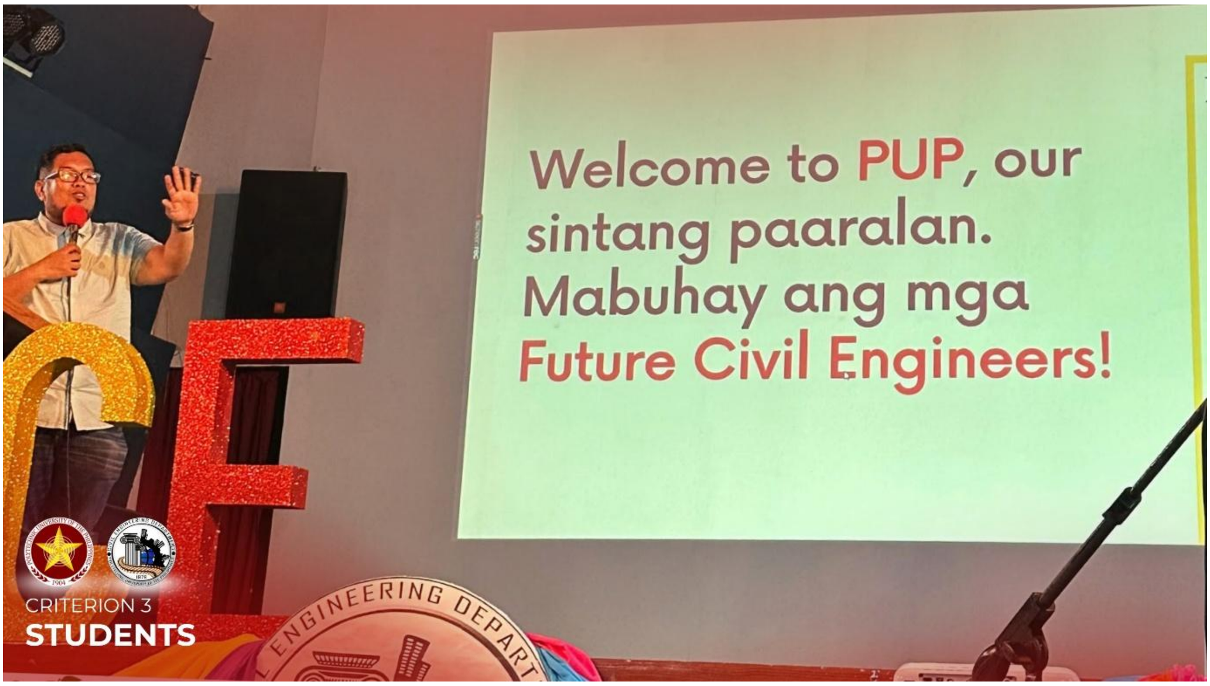

Figure 3.6 Freshmen Orientation for First-Year BS Civil Engineering Students. *The freshmen orientation provides first-year students with essential information on University policies, student responsibilities, curriculum requirements, and available support services. The activity supports student adjustment, policy awareness, and early academic preparedness within the BS Civil Engineering program.*

Student engagement and monitoring are also supported through quarterly general assemblies conducted with class representatives prior to the quarterly faculty meeting. These assemblies serve as a formal communication mechanism between the Department and the student body, providing a venue not only for raising academic, instructional, administrative, and student welfare concerns, but also for disseminating important updates from the Department.

During these assemblies, class representatives are informed of relevant departmental announcements, academic policies, enrollment procedures, curriculum-related reminders, upcoming activities, deadlines, and other matters affecting student progression. Updates on enrollment schedules, course offerings, advising procedures, institutional directives, student requirements, and Department-led programs are discussed to ensure that information is properly communicated to all sections through their respective representatives.

The assemblies also allow student representatives to present concerns, clarifications, and feedback from their classes. These matters are documented, consolidated, and brought to the faculty meeting for appropriate discussion, response, and action planning. This process enables the Department to identify recurring issues, clarify policies, address student needs, and coordinate with concerned faculty members or University offices when necessary.

Through this mechanism, the Department strengthens two-way communication with students by combining information dissemination, consultation, feedback gathering, and action planning. The regular conduct of these assemblies supports timely student advisories, promotes awareness of academic requirements and policies, and contributes to the systematic monitoring of factors affecting student learning, retention, and progression in the BS Civil Engineering program (Attachment C3-15 – Minutes of Quarterly General Assembly).

Figure 3.7 Quarterly General Assembly with Class Representatives. *The quarterly general assembly provides a structured venue for class representatives to present academic and student welfare concerns prior to the faculty meeting. The activity supports timely communication, issue documentation, and coordinated faculty response to matters affecting student progress and learning conditions.*

For students undergoing internship, the Department conducts a **Hardhatting Ceremony and On-the-Job Training Orientation** prior to deployment. This activity formally prepares student interns for their transition from classroom-based learning to actual civil engineering practice environments. During the orientation, students are informed of internship requirements, workplace conduct, safety protocols, documentation requirements, attendance and reporting procedures, communication channels, and expectations from Host Training Establishments (HTEs). The activity also emphasizes the importance of professionalism, ethical behavior, responsibility, discipline, and compliance with workplace rules and safety standards while assigned to industry or government training sites.

The Hardhatting Ceremony also serves as a symbolic and academic milestone that reinforces students' readiness to engage in supervised industry immersion. Through this activity, students are reminded that internship is an integral component of the curriculum where they are expected to apply engineering theories, technical skills, problem-solving abilities, communication skills, and professional values in real-world settings. It also provides the Department an opportunity to clarify student responsibilities, explain evaluation procedures, and ensure that interns understand the required reports, supervisor evaluations, and other documents needed for completion of the internship course. This mechanism supports student preparedness, workplace safety awareness, and the attainment of relevant Course Intended Learning Outcomes and Student Outcomes.

Figure 3.8 Hardhatting Ceremony and On-the-Job Training Orientation. *The Hardhatting Ceremony and OJT Orientation prepare student interns for deployment by discussing safety protocols, professional conduct, internship requirements, and documentation procedures. The activity reinforces readiness for workplace immersion and supports the application of civil engineering competencies in actual practice settings.*

The Department is also supported by alumni in monitoring and enhancing student progress through seminars, professional talks, mentoring activities, and career development sessions. Alumni participation provides students with insights on licensure preparation, industry expectations, specialization pathways, workplace culture, professional ethics, and career opportunities in civil engineering and allied fields. These engagements supplement formal advising by connecting students with graduates who can provide practice-based perspectives and professional guidance.

Figure 3.9 Alumni-Supported Seminar for BS Civil Engineering Students. *Alumni-led seminars provide students with professional insights on industry expectations, licensure preparation, career pathways, and ethical practice in civil engineering. These activities strengthen student awareness of professional realities and supplement the Department's academic and career advising mechanisms.*

The program also implements annual academic and co-curricular activities that serve as supplementary mechanisms for monitoring student progress, particularly in relation to the application of course-based knowledge, practical skills, research capability, teamwork, innovation, and professional communication. These activities provide observable and documented evidence of student performance beyond regular classroom assessments and allow faculty members to evaluate how students apply civil engineering concepts in practical, competitive, and research-oriented settings.

One of these activities is **STRIKE**, a concrete bowling competition conducted for Civil Engineering students enrolled in **CIEN 204 – Materials of Construction and Testing**. The activity provides students with an applied learning platform where they design, prepare, and test a concrete bowling ball and a corresponding concrete cube. Through this activity, students demonstrate their understanding of concrete mix design, material behavior, strength development, quality control, and sustainable construction practices. The requirement to use green and eco-friendly binders encourages students to explore alternative cementitious materials and reinforces environmental responsibility in construction materials engineering.

The STRIKE competition also supports the monitoring of student progress by requiring students to work in teams, prepare concrete specimens, comply with technical specifications, and subject their concrete cube to compression testing. The concrete cube provides a quantifiable basis for evaluating students' understanding of material strength and mix proportioning, while the concrete bowling ball challenges students to apply engineering judgment, creativity, problem-solving, and resource efficiency. In this manner, the activity supports the assessment of practical application, teamwork, communication, technical decision-making, and innovation aligned with the Course Intended Learning Outcomes (CILOs) of CIEN 204 and the applicable Student Outcomes (SOs) (Attachment C3-16 – STRIKE Concrete Bowling Competition Documentation).

Figure 3.10 STRIKE Concrete Bowling Competition for CIEN 204 Students. *The STRIKE competition provides Civil Engineering students with an applied platform to design, construct, and test concrete bowling balls and concrete cubes using sustainable material alternatives. The activity supports the monitoring of student progress in concrete technology, material testing, teamwork, innovation, and practical application of concepts learned in CIEN 204 – Materials of Construction and Testing.*

Another annual activity is **TransConVerge**, a culminating research pitching activity for third-year Civil Engineering students enrolled in the CE Research course. The activity provides students with a platform to present and defend research proposals addressing contemporary issues in infrastructure, transportation systems, railway engineering, sustainable construction, and related civil engineering fields. Through poster exhibits, oral presentations, and research pitching before faculty members and invited professionals, students demonstrate their capacity to identify engineering problems, formulate research objectives, communicate technical ideas, and justify the relevance of their proposed studies.

TransConVerge supports student progress monitoring by providing evidence of students' development in research thinking, technical writing, oral communication, innovation, and professional presentation. The activity also allows the Department to observe students' readiness for thesis development, research collaboration, and participation in academic or professional conferences. Awards such as Best Research Pitch, Best Poster Presentation, and Best Oral Presenter further encourage merit-based recognition of student outputs and promote academic excellence. The results and documentation of the activity serve as supplementary evidence of student development in research, communication, and problem-solving competencies aligned with the applicable CILOs and SOs (Attachment C3-17 – TransConVerge Research Pitching Activity Documentation).

Figure 3.11 TransConVerge Research Pitching Activity. *TransConVerge provides third-year Civil Engineering students with a formal platform to present research proposals through poster exhibits, oral presentations, and research pitching. The activity supports the monitoring of student progress in technical communication, critical thinking, research formulation, innovation, and professional presentation.*

The outcomes of these Department-led activities also provide pathways for students to participate in external, national, and international academic competitions and research presentations. For instance, winning groups from the STRIKE competition may be endorsed to participate in the **Universiti Malaya Civil Engineering Competition (UMCvEC)**, an international civil engineering competition that challenges students to apply engineering knowledge in sustainable and hands-on construction-related tasks. Participation in UMCvEC allows students to benchmark their competencies with peers from other institutions and to demonstrate creativity, material selection, technical testing, teamwork, and environmental responsibility in an international setting.

In **UMCvEC 2025**, PUP BS Civil Engineering students received recognition through the **Best Booth** and **Most Creative and Innovative Award**, demonstrating the capacity of students to translate course-based learning into competitive and externally evaluated outputs. Such participation provides the Department with additional evidence of student achievement, professional confidence, and readiness to engage in broader academic and technical communities.

Figure 3.12 PUP BS Civil Engineering Students at UMCvEC 2025. *PUP BS Civil Engineering students participated in the Universiti Malaya Civil Engineering Competition, applying their knowledge of sustainable concrete design, material selection, and technical presentation in an international setting. Their recognition as recipients of the Best Booth and Most Creative and Innovative Award demonstrates the students' ability to apply course-based competencies in externally evaluated civil engineering activities.*

Similarly, student research outputs developed through program-based research activities may lead to international research presentations and publication opportunities. An example is the students' participation in the **9th International Conference on Green Urbanism organized by IEREK**, held in collaboration with Sapienza University of Rome. The conference provided a platform for students to present research aligned with sustainable and resilient urban development, including themes related to green urban systems, smart and green mobility, climate adaptation, nature-based solutions, urban regeneration, and social sustainability. Student participation in this activity reflects the Department's effort to extend research learning beyond the classroom and to expose students to international scholarly standards.

Through international conference participation, students are able to strengthen their technical communication, research presentation, professional confidence, and awareness of global civil engineering and urban development issues. The opportunity for publication under Springer further supports the development of research competence and lifelong learning. These accomplishments provide indirect and supplementary evidence of student progress in research, communication, innovation, and professional engagement.

Figure 3.13 Student Research Presentation at the 9th International Conference on Green Urbanism. *PUP BS Civil Engineering students presented research outputs in an international conference focused on sustainable and resilient urban development. The activity demonstrates student progress in research communication, technical presentation, global engagement, and application of civil engineering knowledge to contemporary urban challenges.*

These student initiatives are supported by relevant University offices, including the **Office of Student Services**, **Office of International Affairs**, and **Research Management Office**, which provide administrative coordination, institutional endorsement, and budgetary support when applicable. For activities conducted outside the University, participation is guided by CHED requirements on student off-campus activities, particularly the need to ensure proper documentation, institutional approval, safety and welfare measures, and due diligence in the conduct of student mobility and external engagements. CHED Memorandum Order No. 63, s. 2017 emphasizes that higher education institutions must adopt mechanisms to protect the safety and welfare of participants in off-campus activities and observe due diligence in their implementation.

This support enables students to participate in competitions, conferences, and research dissemination activities that contribute to their academic and professional development. The provision of institutional support also strengthens the link between student monitoring, research productivity, internationalization, and outcomes-based education (Attachment C3-18 – Institutional Support for Student Competitions and Research Presentations).

Academic and non-academic student organizations serve as supplementary mechanisms for monitoring student progress by providing observable evidence of student participation, leadership development, professional engagement, and holistic formation. The Department monitors organization-led activities, participation records, accomplishment reports, and documented outputs to identify students' involvement in academic enrichment, peer learning, technical development, community engagement, and co-curricular activities.

Academic organizations support student progress through technical seminars, review sessions, tutorials, competitions, research-related activities, and professional development programs. These activities provide additional indicators of students' engagement with civil engineering concepts, readiness for professional practice, and participation in learning opportunities beyond classroom instruction. Non-academic organizations, on the other hand, contribute to the monitoring of student development in areas such as leadership, communication, teamwork, values formation, community service, and student welfare.

Through the performance and activities of these organizations, the Department is able to observe patterns of student engagement, identify emerging student needs, and provide appropriate academic or developmental support when necessary. Organization reports and activity documentation therefore serve as supplementary evidence in monitoring student growth, supporting student formation, and strengthening the connection between academic learning, professional preparation, and holistic development (Attachment C3-19 – Academic and Non-Academic Organization Activities).

The University enforces strict compliance with prerequisite requirements to maintain academic integrity and ensure readiness for advanced coursework. This is achieved through:

- Adviser validation of course enrollment plans; and
- Automated enrollment system checks that prevent registration in courses without satisfying prerequisites.

The **Student Information System (SIS)** provides real-time monitoring of academic status, enabling:

- Tracking of scholastic standing;
- Detection of incomplete or deficient grades; and
- Decision support for enrollment eligibility.

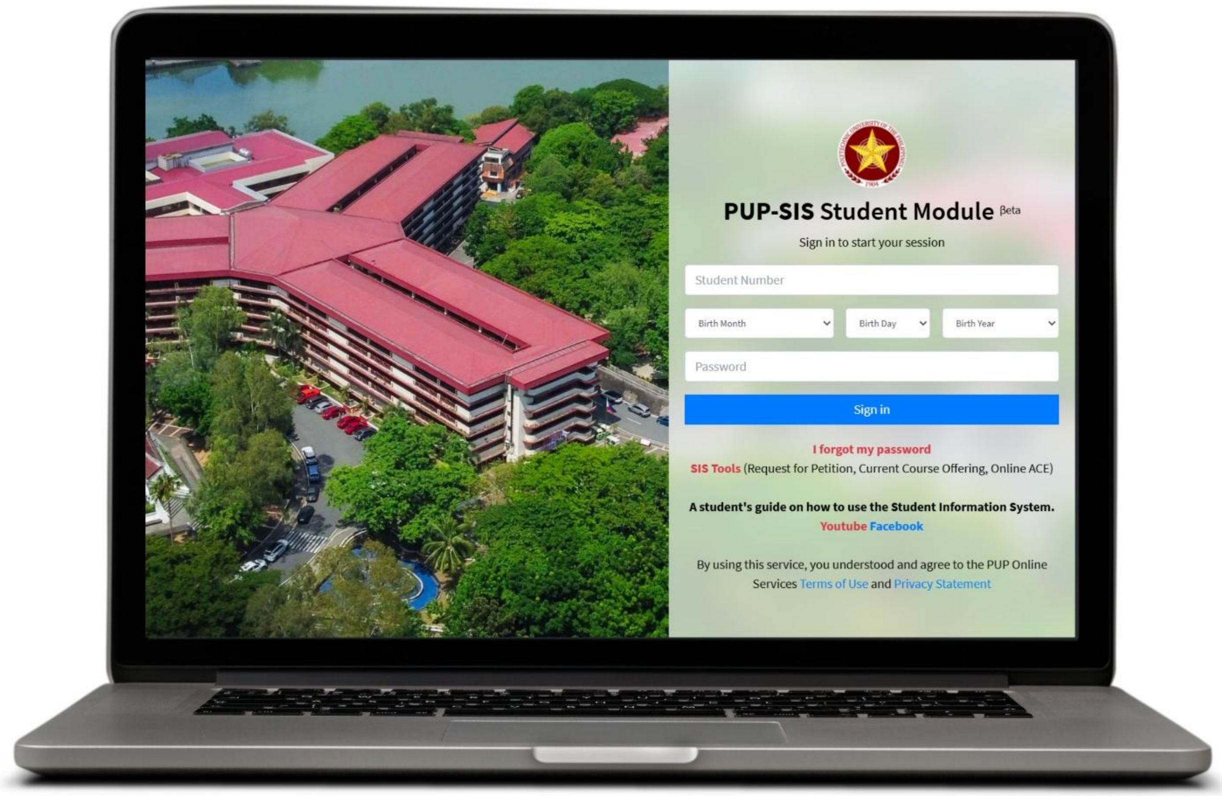

Figure 3.14 The PUP Student Information System

The PUP Student Information System provides an electronic platform for monitoring student academic status, grades, enrollment eligibility, and curriculum progression. It supports faculty advising, prerequisite checking, and timely identification of academic deficiencies requiring appropriate intervention.

Students receiving a grade of **INC (Incomplete)** are required to submit a formal request for completion within the prescribed period. Failure to comply affects eligibility for subsequent course enrollment, thereby reinforcing accountability and ensuring continuity in academic progression.

As part of the Department's monitoring mechanism, an **Exit Survey** is administered to graduating BS Civil Engineering students prior to completion of the program. The survey serves as an indirect assessment tool for determining the extent to which students perceive that they have attained the prescribed **Student Outcomes (SOs)** by the time of graduation. It also provides the Department with relevant information on students' immediate plans after graduation, including licensure examination preparation, employment, further studies, professional certification, or other career pathways.

The Exit Survey gathers feedback on students' academic preparation, perceived competence in technical and professional areas, readiness for civil engineering practice, and satisfaction with the learning experiences provided by the program. The results are used to supplement direct assessment data from course outputs, laboratory activities, design projects, internship reports, and other performance-based assessments. By comparing student perceptions with documented academic performance, the Department obtains a more comprehensive understanding of student readiness and program effectiveness.

The survey also allows the Department to identify areas requiring improvement in instruction, advising, curriculum delivery, student support, and career preparation. Trends in graduates' post-graduation plans are analyzed to determine the extent to which the program supports licensure readiness, employability, lifelong learning, and transition to professional practice. Findings from the Exit Survey are considered in faculty discussions, curriculum review, advising initiatives, and Continuous Quality Improvement (CQI) actions.

Through the implementation of the Exit Survey, the Department strengthens its evidence-based approach to monitoring student progress at the point of program completion. The survey provides documented feedback from graduating students and supports the evaluation of SO attainment, graduate preparedness, and alignment of the BS Civil

Engineering program with the academic and professional needs of its students (Attachment C3-20 – BSCE Exit Survey Instrument and Summary Results).

The Department monitors student progress through a coordinated system that integrates academic records, faculty advising, student portfolios, performance-based assessments, student consultations, guidance services, organizational activities, research engagement, internship preparation, and participation in academic competitions. These mechanisms provide both direct and supplementary evidence of student development and enable the Department to identify academic needs, implement timely interventions, and support the attainment of Student Outcomes (SOs). Through this structured monitoring system, the BS Civil Engineering program promotes timely progression, professional readiness, and continuous improvement in student learning and development.

3.4 Retention

The Polytechnic University of the Philippines (PUP) implements a structured retention policy to ensure that students maintain satisfactory academic performance and progress toward the attainment of the program's Student Outcomes (SOs). The policy is anchored on the provisions of the PUP Student Handbook and is uniformly implemented across colleges to uphold academic standards, promote responsible student progression, and provide a basis for timely academic intervention.

For the BS Civil Engineering program, retention is implemented through both University-wide scholastic standing rules and College-level progression requirements. These mechanisms are intended to ensure that students possess the necessary foundational knowledge, academic discipline, and readiness before proceeding to higher-level engineering science, professional, laboratory, design, and research courses. Retention requirements also support the coherent sequencing of the curriculum by ensuring that students progress only after satisfying the prescribed academic and prerequisite requirements.

In addition to the general retention provisions of the University, the **College of Engineering conducts the Engineering Qualifying Examination (EQE)** for students who are transitioning to higher-year professional engineering courses. Civil Engineering students, upon completion of the first- and second-year requirements, including the National Service Training Program (NSTP), are required to take the College of Engineering Qualifying Examination for incoming third-year students. The EQE serves as a formal academic readiness assessment before students are allowed to enroll in higher major and professional

Civil Engineering subjects (Attachment C3-21 – Guidelines on the PUP Engineering Qualifying Examination).

Students who pass the EQE are permitted to proceed to higher Civil Engineering courses, subject to compliance with other academic and curriculum requirements. Conversely, students who fail the EQE may not be allowed to enroll in higher major or professional subjects until the applicable requirements or conditions under the College guidelines are satisfied. This mechanism ensures that students entering advanced professional courses have demonstrated sufficient preparation in foundational mathematics, basic sciences, engineering sciences, and other prerequisite competencies necessary for success in the succeeding levels of the curriculum.

Figure 3.15 College of Engineering Qualifying Examination. *The Engineering Qualifying Examination was conducted by the College of Engineering as part of the academic progression and retention mechanism for students entering higher-year engineering courses. The examination supports the evaluation of students' readiness to proceed to advanced major and professional subjects in the BS Civil Engineering curriculum.*

The implementation of the EQE supports the program's outcomes-based education framework by strengthening academic screening and progression control within the curriculum. Since higher Civil Engineering courses require advanced analytical ability, engineering judgment, design competence, and integration of technical concepts, the qualifying examination helps ensure that students possess the minimum academic readiness expected before engaging in more complex engineering problems and activities. It also functions as an early intervention mechanism by identifying students who may require additional academic support, advising, remediation, or guidance before proceeding to advanced courses.

Students who fail to meet the retention requirements prescribed by the University, College, or Department may be disqualified from continuing in the program or may be dismissed from the Department, College, or University, depending on the applicable rule and level of academic deficiency. The official requirement and guidelines for the College of Engineering Qualifying Examination are adopted and implemented in the BS Civil Engineering program as part of its retention and progression system.

Other retention requirements are those stated in the PUP Student Handbook. Students who fail to meet these retention requirements may be subjected to warning, reduction in academic load, probation, dismissal from the College, or dismissal from the University, depending on the percentage of failed academic units and the recurrence of scholastic deficiency. These provisions provide a clear and systematic basis for determining the academic standing of students and the corresponding actions to be taken by the College or University.

Under the institutional retention policy, each college shall implement the following rules on scholastic delinquency:

Warning: Any student who at the end of the semester, obtains final grades of “5” in 15% or less of the total number of academic units in which he/she is registered shall be warned by the Dean or Director concerned to improve his/her academic performance. If he/she fails or gets incomplete marks in 16 - 30% of the total number of registered academic units, he/ she shall be warned by the Dean/Director, and his/her load shall be reduced by three (3) units.

Probation. (a) Any student who, at the end of the semester obtains final grades of “5” in 31-50% of the total number of academic units in which he/she has enrolled shall be placed on probation for the succeeding semester and his/her academic load shall be correspondingly reduced by six (6) units by the Dean or Director concerned; (b) Any student who has received two successive warnings shall be placed on probation. Probation may be lifted the following semester if the student passes all of his/ her subjects in which he/she has final failing grades. (c) Any student who has been placed on probation for two successive semesters shall be dropped from the rolls of his/her College. However, he/she may be readmitted to another College of the University where he/she qualifies; and (d) Any student on probation who again fails in 50% or more of the total number of units in which he/she is enrolled for the semester shall be dropped from the rolls of the University.

Dismissal. Any student who, at the end of the semester, obtains final grades of “5” in 5l%-75% of the total number of academic units shall be dropped from the rolls of the College concerned; if more than 75%, he/she shall be dismissed from the University and be permanently disqualified from readmission to the University**.**

3.5 Transfer Students and Transfer Courses

3.5.1 Transferring within the PUP System

A student seeking transfer from one PUP branch or campus to another within the University system may be considered for admission subject to the availability of program slots and institutional capacity. This policy ensures equitable access while maintaining program quality and resource adequacy.

The student must:

a. Have a recommendation from the Director of the branch where he/she came from.
b. Have completed at least two (2) semesters.
c. Have no failing grade, dropped, or withdrawn mark in any academic subject.
d. Have met the college academic course/program requirements; and
e. Have submitted the following requirements to the Admission Services:
    i. Transfer Credential/Honorable Dismissal
    ii. Certification of Grades/Transcript of Records for evaluation purposes
    iii. Receipt of Admission Fee payment
    iv. PSA Copy of Birth Certificate
    v. Receipt of Admission fee payment, and
    vi. Curriculum sheet

3.5.2 Transferring from another School

A student seeking transfer from another higher education institution to the Polytechnic University of the Philippines (PUP) may be admitted subject to the availability of program slots and the approval of the University President or his duly authorized representative. This policy ensures controlled admission aligned with institutional capacity, academic standards, and program requirements.

The student must:

a. have passed the psychological test.
b. have completed two (2) semesters or one (1) year (equivalent to 36 units only) for the last two (2) years in any four- or five-year program/degree/course in the school/university where he/she came from.
c. have a weighted average of 2.0 or better with no failed, dropped or withdrawn subjects.
d. have met the college academic program/course requirements.
e. have submitted the following requirements:
f. Honorable Dismissal/Transfer Credentials
g. Transcript of Records
h. Certification of good moral character with the school/university dry seal
i. Course/Subject Description taken from another school/university.
j. PSA Copy of Birth Certificate
k. Medical Clearance from the University Clinic
l. two (2) pcs. 2x2 picture with name tag
m. Receipt of Admission fee payment, and
n. Curriculum sheet

3.5.3 Transfer Courses

Accreditation of Subjects - The subjects taken by a transferee from another school, which may be considered as reasonable equivalents of subjects in the University curriculum, shall be given credit, subject to validation and approval by the Dean/Director concerned, and the University Registrar.

Admission Certificate - The transferring student will be issued by the Admission Services the corresponding admission certificate to be used for enrollment purposes.

3.6 Advising and Career Guidance

Effective academic advising and career guidance are integral components of the Polytechnic University of the Philippines' (PUP) student support system, ensuring that students are guided toward successful completion of their academic program and attainment of the defined Student Outcomes (SOs). The University implements a structured advising mechanism to equip students with essential knowledge about academic policies, career pathways, employment opportunities, and available instructional support services. Incoming freshmen and transfer students are provided with academic counseling by a faculty member to develop an individualized plan of study. This plan is reviewed regularly in collaboration with the faculty adviser and revised as necessary to ensure academic progress. Students are also guided in understanding graduation requirements. Ultimately, however, the responsibility for fulfilling all degree requirements rests with the student.

Faculty advisers play a vital role in guiding students on curriculum planning, career development, and preparation for admission to graduate and professional schools. They also help connect students with additional advising and counseling resources, including opportunities for internships, independent research, and guided independent studies. Faculty members of the program are expected to make every effort to be accessible to their advisees. Students are strongly encouraged to maintain regular communication with their assigned faculty advisers and to seek guidance before making any changes to their plan of study. Additionally, students are required to consult with their Program Chair prior to enrolling each semester.

Figure 3.16 *The PUP 2024 Career Fest, held from March 13 to 15, 2024, provided 2,889 graduating students with Labor and Employment Education Services facilitated by the Department of Labor and Employment–National Capital Region. The activity included Labor Education for Graduating Students seminars and an orientation on SSS social protection to strengthen students' awareness of workplace rights, responsibilities, and employee welfare.*

The **Guidance and Counseling Office** serves as a complementary support unit in the academic advising system by providing specialized assistance to students with academic, personal, psychosocial, and career-related concerns. While faculty advisers primarily guide students on curriculum progression, course enrollment, academic standing, and professional preparation, the Guidance and Counseling Office provides intervention services for concerns that require counseling, behavioral support, adjustment assistance, or career clarification. This ensures that student support is not limited to academic performance monitoring but also addresses factors that may affect persistence, well-being, and successful completion of the program.

A dedicated guidance counselor is assigned to the College to provide accessible and responsive support services to students. Students may be referred to the Guidance and Counseling Office by faculty advisers, the Program Chair, faculty members, or other authorized personnel when concerns related to academic performance, attendance, behavior, motivation, personal adjustment, interpersonal relationships, or emotional well-being are observed. Students may also seek counseling voluntarily when they require assistance in managing academic pressure, career uncertainty, personal concerns, or adjustment to university life.

The guidance process is documented through guidance slips, referral forms, counseling forms, and follow-up records. These documents indicate the nature of the concern, recommendations given, actions taken, and progress observed during follow-up sessions. When appropriate, the guidance counselor coordinates with faculty advisers, the Program Chair, or concerned academic offices to ensure that necessary academic or developmental interventions are implemented while maintaining confidentiality and professional standards. These records provide evidence that student concerns are systematically documented, monitored, and addressed through appropriate support mechanisms (Attachment C3-22 – Guidance Slips and Counseling Forms).

In addition to individual counseling and referral services, the Guidance and Counseling Office conducts enrichment seminars and developmental activities that support students' self-awareness, values formation, goal setting, interest exploration, decision-making, and skills development. For BS Civil Engineering students, these services contribute to professional preparation by supporting the development of discipline, resilience, communication, ethical awareness, and readiness for workplace expectations.

Through the coordinated efforts of faculty advisers, the Program Chair, and the Guidance and Counseling Office, students are provided with a structured advising and support system that promotes both academic success and holistic development. This mechanism strengthens student retention, supports timely intervention, and contributes to the attainment of Student Outcomes (SOs) related to professional responsibility, communication, teamwork, lifelong learning, and readiness for civil engineering practice.

3.6.1 PUP Alumni Relations and Career Development Office (ARCDO)

The Alumni Relations and Career Development Office (ARCDO) provides comprehensive career placement and professional development services to PUP students and alumni, including those enrolled in the Bachelor of Science in Civil Engineering (BSCE) program. The office serves as a bridge between alumni, students, and the University, facilitating professional networking, mentorship, and access to career opportunities.

ARCDO coordinates with external partners to advance career development, employment placement, and experiential learning for students and graduates. Services include career talks, placement simulations, job postings, job fairs, and alumni engagement programs, all designed to enhance students' professional readiness. For BSCE students, these activities specifically align with competencies expected in civil engineering practice, supporting employment in areas such as structural engineering, transportation, water resources, construction management, and geotechnical engineering.

Figure 3.17 *The PUP–DPWH Campus Job Fair provided students, fresh graduates, and newly licensed professionals with direct access to employment opportunities in public infrastructure and government service. The initiative supported SDG 8 by promoting meaningful employment and SDG 10 by expanding equitable career opportunities for students from diverse and underserved backgrounds.*

A notable example of ARCDO's initiatives is the PUP–DPWH Campus Job Fair. Approximately 700 students and alumni, including those from the College of Engineering, participated in the fair, seeking opportunities to join the Department of Public Works and Highways (DPWH). The event was formally supported by University President who highlighted its role in connecting students to careers that directly contribute to national infrastructure development. DPWH officials emphasized the need for young professionals with technical competence, integrity, and a commitment to public service. BSCE graduates attending the fair expressed appreciation for the guidance, mentorship, and potential career pathways provided, citing inspiration from industry and government leaders to pursue impactful engineering careers.

The fair also reflects the University's commitment to the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), particularly SDG 8 on decent work and economic growth and SDG 10 on reducing inequalities, by providing equitable access to meaningful career opportunities for students from diverse and underserved backgrounds.

Through these programs, ARCDO ensures that BSCE students and graduates are equipped for gainful and relevant employment, able to demonstrate professional excellence, and supported in achieving lifelong learning and career advancement. The office's efforts strengthen the alignment between academic preparation and industry expectations, fostering a seamless transition from university training to professional practice in civil engineering.

ALUMNI RELATIONS SERVICES

- Database Management
- Alumni Engagement Activities
- Fundraising/Donation
- Courtesy and Campus Visits
- Balik Sintang Paaralan Alumni Webinar Series
- Alumni Profiling
- Alumni Interviews and Testimonials
- Kwentong Dose Pesos Magazine

STUDENT PLACEMENT SUPPORT AND ENGAGEMENT

- PREPI Bootcamp
- Exclusive Onsite Recruitment of Companies
- Job Fairs
- Referrals and Recommendations
- Job Postings
- Tech Talks

CAREER INFORMATION SERVICES

- Career Development Resources
- Career Assessment, Counseling, Coaching and Advising
- Programs
- Job Posting Services

STUDENT SUPPORT AND TRAINING PROGRAM SERVICES

- Career Development Talks/Orientations/Seminars
- Exposure to Partner Industries through:
    - Company/Industry Tours
    - On-the-Job-Training Fairs
    - Resume Reviews and Virtual Practice with Industry Experts

FOR EMPLOYERS

- **Job Postings and On-the-Job-Training Vacancies:** Updated opportunities are posted via bulletin boards, PUP, and ARCDO official social media platforms.
- **Graduates/Alumni Directory:** A comprehensive list of graduates provided to potential employers for recruitment purposes.

EMPLOYER'S CAMPUS ENGAGEMENT

Activities to foster networking between employers and students:

- Graduates/Alumni Directory
  Casual information-sharing sessions between employers and students.
- Employer Lobby Events
  A showcase of job opportunities and career paths from up to five companies.
- Exclusive On-Campus Interviews
  Scheduled interviews for jobs or internships hosted by the PUP Career Center.
- Job Fairs
  Organized biannually for student-employer networking and hiring.
- Industry Testimonials
- Mock Recruitments
- Webinar & Online Workshops
  Host virtual sessions on career advice, industry insights on company deep dive.

ACADEME-INDUSTRY PARTNERSHIP

The Department of Civil Engineering of the Polytechnic University of the Philippines (PUP) maintains a robust framework for collaboration with industry partners, encompassing both community engagement initiatives and on-the-job training (OJT) programs. As of December 2024, the University has formalized over 200 Memoranda of Agreement (MOA) and Memoranda of Understanding (MOU) with industry and government entities, with each agreement valid for three to five years. These partnerships provide structured, sustained opportunities for student experiential learning, faculty-industry collaboration, and applied research, thereby enhancing both professional readiness and community responsiveness.

***Figure 3.18** The Government–Industry Advisory Board Meeting held on April 11, 2024 provided a formal platform for consultation between the Department of Civil Engineering and its external stakeholders. The meeting facilitated the review of program initiatives, industry expectations, and recommendations supporting curriculum enhancement and Continuous Quality Improvement.*

The partnerships are guided by ongoing consultations with the Government Industry Advisory Board (GIAB), where institutional developments, student outcomes, and program objectives are presented for external validation and stakeholder feedback (Attachment C3-23 – Memorandum Orders and Minutes of the Government Industry Advisory Board Meetings). The Department leverages these engagements to align OJT and research experiences with industry standards, promote community-responsive projects, and ensure that student exposure to practical challenges is both consistent and meaningful. For instance, stakeholder recommendations from the GIAB emphasized the establishment of multi-year MOAs with companies handling long-term projects to guarantee sustained and progressive student learning opportunities.

In addition, the Department integrates partnership initiatives into the broader Continuous Quality Improvement (CQI) framework. Student OJT assignments, research projects, and community-based interventions are continuously evaluated for alignment with Program Educational Objectives (PEOs) and Student Outcomes (SOs). Feedback from alumni, employers, and industry representatives informs improvements in curriculum design, instructional delivery, and assessment methodologies. Stakeholder consultations have further highlighted the need for specialization-sensitive assessment, enhanced field and laboratory exposure, and integration of emerging tools such as AI and digital modeling technologies, ensuring that partnerships actively contribute to the professional development of graduates.

Collectively, these academe-industry partnerships demonstrate the Department's commitment to fostering industry-informed, community-responsive, and outcomes-driven education. They not only provide students with authentic experiential learning but also strengthen the Department's capacity to adapt to evolving professional standards, promote innovation in research, and continuously enhance the quality and relevance of its academic programs.

3.7 Work in Lieu of Courses

The program does not accept work instead of courses. The University has a Unit under the Open University System, Institute of Non-Traditional Study Program (NTSP) and Expanded Tertiary Education Equivalency and Accreditation Program (ETEEAP).

As defined in Section 3 of Republic Act (RA) 12124 – the ETEEAP Act, enacted on March 3, 2025, the Expanded Tertiary Education Equivalency and Accreditation Program is a comprehensive alternative learning program offered by the government for tertiary education (Attachment C3-24 – Republic Act No. 12124). It is based on academic equivalency, accreditation, validation, and recognition of prior learning—knowledge and expertise gained through relevant work experience and formal, non-formal, and informal training that helps harness the student's full potential. As an integral part of the tertiary education system, ETEEAP allows individuals, including high school graduates, senior high school graduates, post-secondary technical-vocational graduates, and college undergraduates, to obtain an undergraduate degree. It also provides an opportunity for working professionals who were unable to finish or advance in college, or those who have earned a bachelor's degree and wish to pursue a special graduate degree, without going through traditional schooling methods.

Using equivalency competence standards and a comprehensive assessment system that employs written tests and combined assessment methodologies, a higher education institution may administer competency-based evaluations as the basis for accrediting learning experiences.

A panel of assessors is convened to evaluate the candidate's knowledge, skills, and attitudes relevant to a particular discipline. Based on this assessment, equivalent credits, along with the appropriate certificates and degrees, are awarded by the administering higher education institutions

3.8 Graduation Requirements

The University confers a degree only upon students who have satisfactorily completed all academic and non-academic requirements prescribed in the approved curriculum, as verified through their official records in the **Office of the University Registrar** and **the Student Information System (SIS)**. For the BS Civil Engineering program, this process ensures that graduating students have completed all required general education courses, mathematics and basic sciences, engineering sciences, professional civil engineering courses, laboratory requirements, design courses, internship, research, institutional requirements, and other prescribed academic components of the curriculum.

The Office of the University Registrar is responsible for the formal evaluation and validation of each student’s graduation requirements. This evaluation ensures that the student has earned the required number of units, obtained passing grades in all courses, resolved academic deficiencies, completed clearance requirements, and complied with all applicable University policies. The evaluation process also verifies that the courses completed by the student are consistent with the approved BS Civil Engineering curriculum and that all prerequisite and course sequencing requirements have been satisfied. Through this procedure, the University ensures that only students who have fully complied with academic, administrative, and institutional requirements are included in the official list of candidates for graduation. The graduation evaluation process is carried out systematically through coordination among the Office of the University Registrar, the College, and the Department. Students are required to apply for graduation within the prescribed period, after which their academic records are reviewed to determine completion status and identify any remaining deficiencies.

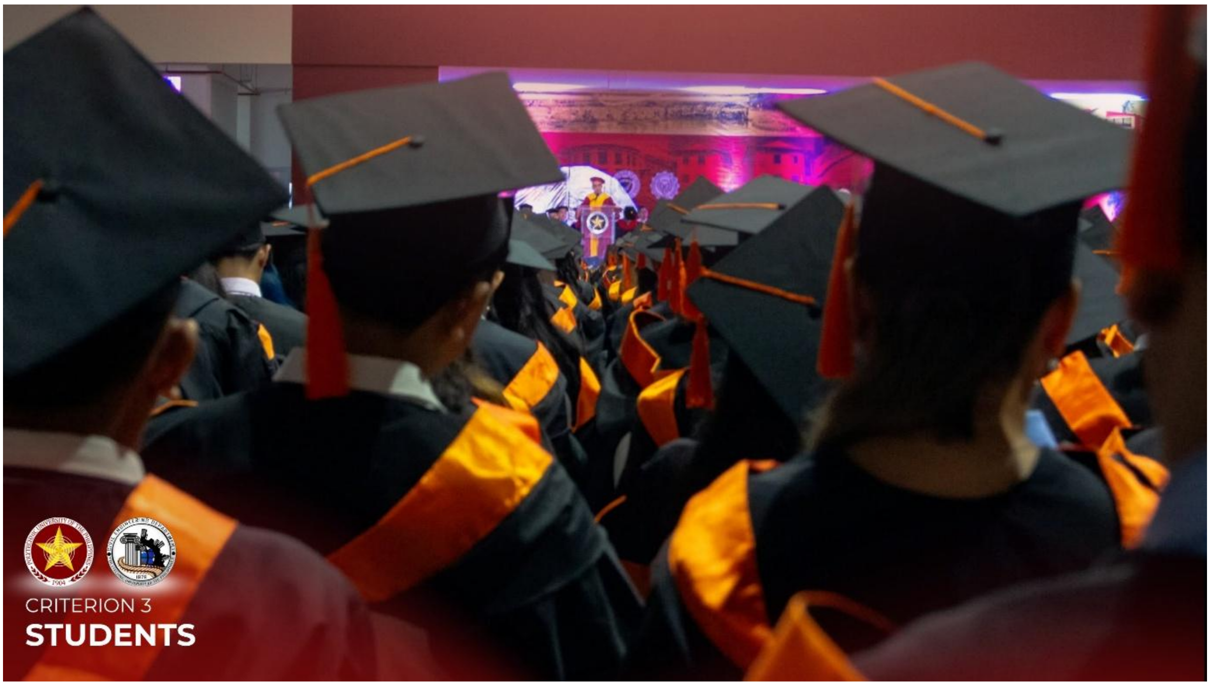

Figure 3.19 Commencement Exercises of the College of Engineering. *The commencement exercises formally recognize students who have satisfactorily completed all academic and non-academic requirements prescribed by the University and the BS Civil Engineering curriculum. The activity represents the final stage of the student academic lifecycle and affirms the University's verification of graduates' eligibility for degree conferment.*

Evaluation: Students are required to file an application for the evaluation of academic credits prior to their final semester in the program. A staff member from the Registrar's Office reviews, verifies, and evaluates the student's academic records. The results of the evaluation are then sent to the student's institutional email address. Any deficiencies identified by the Registrar must be completed within the student's final semester.

Deliberation: A preliminary deliberation is conducted once midterm grades are available. A list of graduating candidates, including any identified deficiencies, is then sent via email to both the students and the respective college for appropriate action.

Announcement: The final list of graduates is released to the respective colleges via email after all deficiencies have been resolved and verified. Students are then required to settle their graduation fees and complete the necessary clearance procedures. Completed clearances must be submitted to the Registrar's Office for final verification and processing.

Application for graduation

- A candidate for graduation shall file his/her application for graduation online using his/her SIS account within the period indicated in the University calendar.
- An application for graduation of the student can be processed only if he/she obtained passing grades in all his/her subjects required in the curriculum.
- A student shall be recommended for graduation when he/she has satisfied all academic and other requirements prescribed by the University.
- A candidate for graduation shall have his/her deficiencies completed and his/her records cleared not later than two weeks before the end of his/her last semester.
- All candidates for graduation are required to attend the graduation or commencement rites, as no degree is conferred in absentia.
- No graduate shall be issued a Diploma and a Transcript of Records unless he/she has been cleared of all accountabilities.

The annual number of graduating students reflects the program's student completion trends and its capacity to support learners through the prescribed curriculum and graduation requirements. Figure 3.20 and Table 3.1 present the corresponding annual data for the period under review.

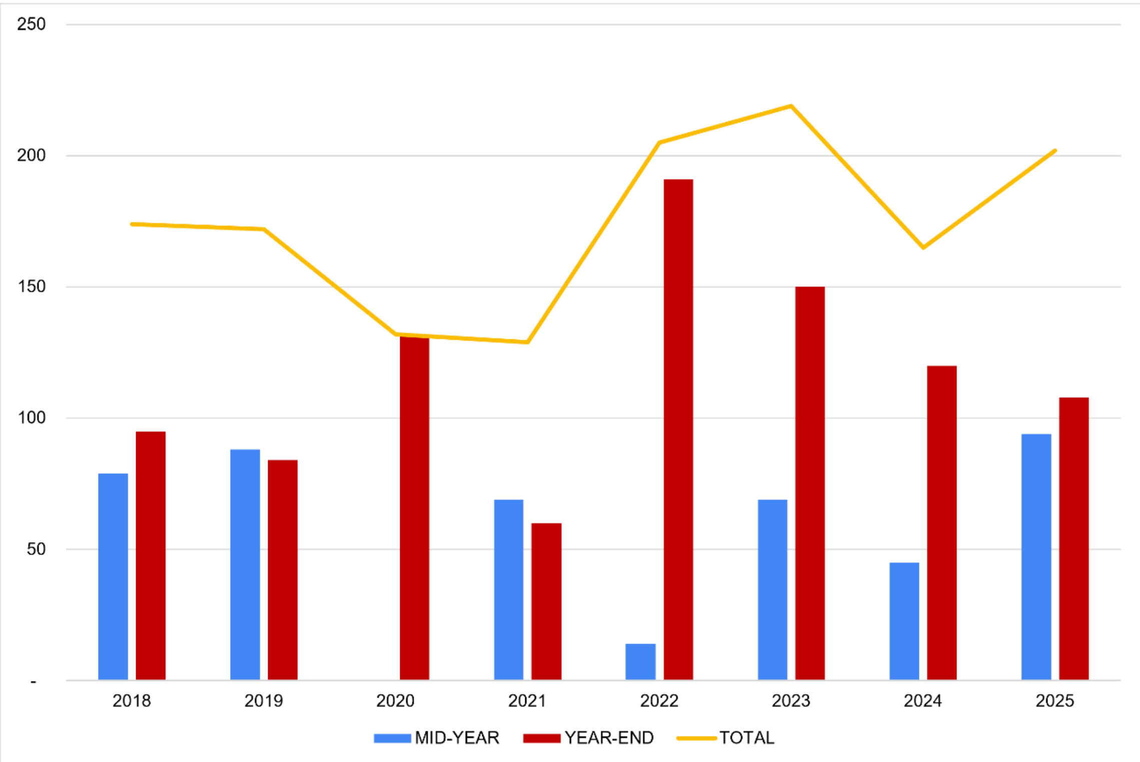

Figure 3.20 Historical Data on Annual Graduation for the Civil Engineering Programs

The historical graduation data for the BS Civil Engineering program indicate that a total of 1,398 students completed the program from Fiscal Year 2018 to Fiscal Year 2025. Of this number, 940 students graduated during the year-end term, while 458 students completed their degree during the mid-year term, demonstrating that the majority of program completions occurred at the end of the regular academic cycle.

Table 3.1 Historical Data on Annual Graduation for the Civil Engineering Programs

BS Civil Engineering Graduates, from FY 2018 to FY 2025									
Fiscal Year	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	Total
Mid-Year	79	88		69	14	69	45	94	458
Year-End	95	84	132	60	191	150	120	108	940
Total	**174**	**172**	**132**	**129**	**205**	**219**	**165**	**202**	**1,398**

Annual graduation figures varied across the period, ranging from 129 graduates in 2021 to 219 graduates in 2023. Following fluctuations observed from 2020 to 2021, the number of graduates increased to 205 in 2022 and reached its highest level in 2023. Although the total declined to 165 in 2024, it subsequently increased to 202 graduates in 2025, indicating continued student progression and degree completion within the program.

3.9 Transcript of Recent Graduates

The **Transcript of Records (TOR)** serves as the official academic record of graduates and provides verifiable evidence that students have completed the prescribed curricular requirements of the BS Civil Engineering program. It reflects the courses taken, grades earned, academic terms completed, credited units, and degree conferred, thereby supporting the validation of student progression, curriculum compliance, and graduation eligibility.

The preparation, verification, and release of the Transcript of Records are administered by the **Office of the University Registrar** in accordance with University policies and records management procedures. Prior to graduation, the Registrar evaluates each candidate's academic records to confirm that all required courses, units, and institutional requirements have been satisfactorily completed. Only students whose academic and non-academic requirements have been cleared are included in the final list of graduates and become eligible for the issuance of official academic documents.

The University observes appropriate procedures in the handling of student academic records to ensure confidentiality, accuracy, and integrity of information. Access to transcripts and related documents is limited to authorized personnel and is provided for accreditation review only when required. (Attachment C3-25 – Transcript of Recent Graduates).

3.10 Academic Exchange

The Office of International Affairs administers and coordinates faculty and student exchange programs with partner higher education institutions outside the Philippines. Its responsibilities include facilitating institutional agreements, coordinating mobility requirements, assisting participants with academic and administrative documentation, and ensuring that exchange activities comply with University policies and the provisions of the applicable partnership agreements.

International exchange programs may be classified as inbound or outbound and as either long-term or short-term, depending on the duration and nature of the engagement. These programs must be academic in purpose and implemented under a formal agreement between PUP and the participating higher education institution. For reporting purposes, credit-bearing student mobility activities lasting less than one semester are not classified as long-term student exchange programs. Through these arrangements, students and faculty gain opportunities for academic enrichment, intercultural engagement, knowledge exchange, and exposure to international educational practices.

The international exchange programs must be between universities, not between a university and a company or corporation, or a university with its international/offshore campuses:

- **Long-term Inbound Faculty Exchange** refers to faculty members attending the university on an international exchange program for at least one semester during the annual reporting period.
- **Short-term Inbound Faculty Exchange** refers to faculty members attending the university on international exchange programs lasting between (2) to less than twelve (12) weeks.
- **Long-term Outbound Faculty Exchange** refers to faculty members registered in the university who have attended another university abroad on international exchange programs for at least one semester during the annual reporting period.
- **Short-term Outbound Faculty Exchange** refers to faculty members on an organized international trip or exchange program lasting between two (2) and twelve (12) weeks.

- **Long-term Inbound Exchange Students** refer to undergraduate and postgraduate students attending the university on international exchange programs for at least one semester during the annual reporting period.
- **Short-term Inbound Exchange Students** refer to undergraduate and postgraduate students attending the university on international exchange programs lasting between (2) to less than twelve (12) weeks.
- **Long-term Outbound Exchange Students** refer to undergraduate and postgraduate students registered in the university who have attended another university abroad on international exchange programs for at least one semester during the annual reporting period.
- **Short-term Outbound Exchange Students** refer to students on an organized international trip or exchange program lasting between two (2) and twelve (12) weeks.

The Bachelor of Science in Civil Engineering program demonstrates a comprehensive, transparent, and outcomes-oriented system for managing the student academic lifecycle, from admission to graduation. The program's student policies and procedures are anchored on institutional governance, national regulations, and quality assurance mechanisms that promote fairness, accessibility, academic rigor, and student accountability. Through structured admission processes, selective retention standards, systematic evaluation of student performance, faculty-led academic and career advising, student portfolio monitoring, and clearly defined graduation requirements, the program ensures that students are progressively guided toward the attainment of Program Educational Objectives (PEOs), Student Outcomes (SOs), and long-term professional readiness.

The integration of student support services, guidance and counseling, career development initiatives, alumni and industry engagement, transfer and ladderized pathways, international student support, and academic exchange opportunities further strengthens the inclusiveness and relevance of the student experience. Collectively, these mechanisms provide evidence of the program's commitment to student development, continuous quality improvement, and the preparation of competent, ethical, globally responsive, and practice-ready civil engineering graduates.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment C3-01 – Presidential Decree No. 1341

Attachment C3-02 – Student Admission Record Form or Confirmation Slip

Attachment C3-03 – PUP Student Handbook

Attachment C3-04 – BOR Approval of the PUP Student Handbook

Attachment C3-05 – PUP Admission Criteria

Attachment C3-06 – Executive Order No. 42, Series of 2021

Attachment C3-07 – Executive Order No. 20, Series of 2023

Attachment C3-08 – Republic Act No. 10931

Attachment C3-09 – Students' Plan of Study

Attachment C3-10 – Assessment Rubrics

Attachment C3-11 – Direct and Indirect Assessment of CILOs and SOs

Attachment C3-12 – Special Order on Faculty Academic Advisers

Attachment C3-13 – Academic and Career Advising Form

Attachment C3-14 – Student Portfolio

Attachment C3-15 – Minutes of Quarterly General Assembly

Attachment C3-16 – STRIKE Concrete Bowling Competition Documentation

Attachment C3-17 – TransConVerge Research Pitching Activity Documentation

Attachment C3-18 – Institutional Support for Student Competitions and Research Presentations

Attachment C3-19 – Academic and Non-Academic Organization Activities

Attachment C3-20 – BSCE Exit Survey Instrument and Summary Results

Attachment C3-21 – Guidelines on the PUP Engineering Qualifying Examination

Attachment C3-22 – Guidance Slips and Counseling Forms

Attachment C3-23 – Memorandum Orders and Minutes of the Government Industry Advisory Board Meetings

Attachment C3-24 – Republic Act No. 12124

Attachment C3-25 – Transcript of Recent Graduates